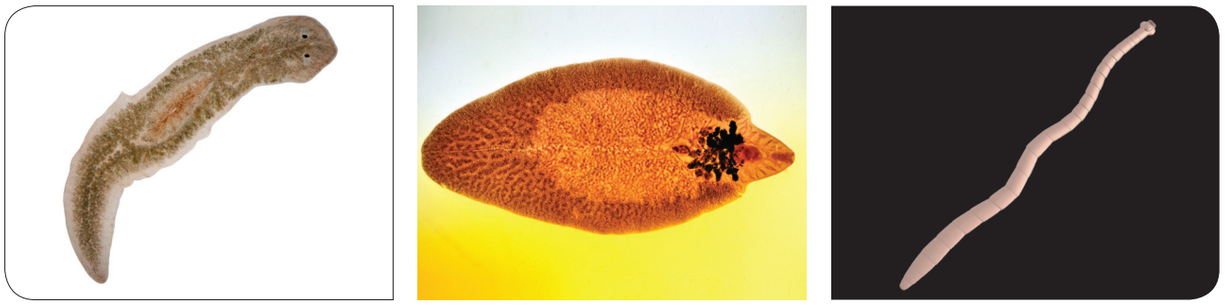


Planaria *Liverfluke* *Tapeworm*

Figure 2.12 Examples of Platyhelminthes

is common in some flatworms (Liver flukes). Some members like *Planaria* show high regeneration capacity (Figure 2.12).

Examples: *Taenia solium* (Tape worm), *Fasciola hepatica* (Liver fluke), *Schistosoma* (Blood fluke).

2.3.5 Phylum: Aschelminthes (Round Worms)

(G. *Askes* –cavity; *helminths* – worms)

Previously called Nematoda, this phylum is now named as Aschelminthes. The body of these worms is circular (round) in cross section and hence are called round worms. They are free living or parasitic on aquatic and terrestrial plants and animals. They are bilaterally symmetrical, triploblastic and pseudocoelomate animals with organ system level of organisation. The body is unsegmented and covered by a transparent, tough and protective collagenous layer called cuticle. The alimentary canal is complete with a well developed mouth, muscular pharynx and anus. Excretory system consists of renette glands. Sexes are separate; and exhibit sexual dimorphism; often females are longer than males. Fertilisation is internal; majority are oviparous (e.g. *Ascaris*) few are ovoviviparous (*Wuchereria*). Development may be direct or indirect.

Examples. *Ascaris lumbricoides* (Round worm), *Enterobius vermicularis* (Pin worm), *Wuchereria bancrofti* (Filarial worm), *Ancylostomaa deuodenale* (Hook worm) (Figure 2.13).

2.3.6 Phylum: Annelida (Segmented worm)

(L. *annulus* -a ring, and G. *edios*- form)

Annelids were the first segmented animals to evolve. They are aquatic or terrestrial, free living but some are parasitic. They are triploblastic, bilaterally



Ascaris *Filarial worm* *Hook worm*

Figure 2.13 Examples of Aschelminthes

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